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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Epstein: Trump aware of girls

Email says president spent hours with one of financier's victims

By Michael R. Sisak and Eric Tucker
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — Jeffrey Epstein wrote in a 2019 email to a journalist that Donald Trump “knew about the girls,” according to documents made public Wednesday, but what he knew — and whether it pertained to the sex offender's crimes — is unclear. The White House quickly accused Democrats of selectively leaking the emails to smear the president.

Democrats on the House Oversight Committee released three emails referencing Trump, including one Epstein wrote in 2011 in which he told confidant Ghislaine Maxwell that Trump had “spent hours” at Epstein's house with a sex trafficking victim.

The disclosures seemed designed to raise new questions about Trump's friendship with Epstein and about what knowledge he may have had regarding what prosecutors call a yearslong effort by Epstein to exploit underage girls. The Republican businessman-turned-politician has consistently denied any knowledge of Epstein's crimes and has said he ended their relationship years ago.

The version of the 2011 email released by the Democrats redacted the name of the victim, but Republicans on the committee later said it was Virginia Giuffre, who accused Epstein of arranging for her to have sexual encounters with a number of his rich and powerful friends.

Epstein took his own life in a New York jail in 2019 while awaiting trial on federal charges.

The emails made public Wednesday are part of a batch of 23,000 documents provided

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Federal officers detain a person in Chicago's Little Village neighborhood on Saturday. ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Judge promises to free hundreds of detainees

Ruling hinges on warrantless arrests, says feds clearly not targeting criminals

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

A federal judge on Wednesday said he plans to grant bond to hundreds of immigrants whose arrests during Operation Midway Blitz are being challenged under a consent decree that limits so-called warrantless arrests that occur without a prior warrant or probable cause.

In a packed hearing at Chicago's federal courthouse, U.S. District Judge Jeffrey Cummings ordered the immediate release of 13 people whose arrests the Department of Justice agreed violated the 2022 agreement.

The judge also told lawyers

for the government to produce a list by Nov. 19 detailing how many of a subset of 615 class members were still in custody, and whether they qualified for mandatory detention due to a prior criminal history or removal order.

Unless a detainee was shown to be a security risk, Cummings said he would allow their release on a \$1,500 bond and some form of monitoring, including electronic ankle monitors, pending the outcome of immigration proceedings. Most of those arrested were originally processed at the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement facility in west suburban Broadview, but have since been moved

to jails around the country.

Meanwhile, Cummings' decision will ultimately affect a much wider segment of the thousands of arrests made by ICE and U.S. Border Patrol in Chicago since the Trump administration's enhanced immigration-enforcement operations.

So far, the government has identified more than 3,300 such arrests, the vast majority of which plaintiffs' attorneys believe will prove to be unlawful.

In explaining his decision, Cummings read from a summary he and his law clerks compiled from more than 150 ongoing immigration petitions in federal

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TEACHER IN DETENTION

A judge ruled that a day care teacher's detention is illegal and she must be given a bond hearing. **Chicagoland, Page 2**

'DISSENT IS NOT A CRIME'

Congressional candidate Katherine “Kat” Abughazaleh vowed Wednesday to fight federal conspiracy charges stemming from a protest last month in Broadview. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

BROADVIEW TOUR ON TAP

Attorneys alleging inhumane conditions will be allowed to take photos and talk to detainees inside the facility. **Chicagoland, Page 4**



A motorist charges an EV at a lot in Chicago's Pullman neighborhood on Tuesday. JOHN J. KIM/TRIBUNE

State sees record EV sales bump

End of tax credits key to temporary demand

By Olivia Olander
Chicago Tribune

Illinois squeaked in a record share of electric vehicle sales last quarter, on par with a national trend tied to the Trump administration's decision to end lucrative federal tax credits.

Still, the state remains far short of Gov. JB Pritzker's ongoing push to get 1 million electric vehicles on Illinois roads by 2030.

“Sales definitely went up,” Jeff Foltz, president of the independent market analysis firm Auto Outlook, said of purchases both in Illinois and across the country as the end of the tax credit pulled demand forward. “We saw it measured here in market share, and to me, it does speak to demand for battery electric vehicles.”

The third quarter of this year saw EV sales grow to 8.4% of overall vehicle sales in Illinois, a record, according to data from Experian Automotive published in Illinois Auto Outlook, a local

publication of Foltz's group. That was up a percentage point from the same period last year and from 7.1% the previous quarter, the data showed.

The bump in EV purchases followed President Donald Trump's administration and congressional Republicans' decision to end federal tax credits of up to \$7,500 for new electric vehicles and \$4,000 for used EVs at the end of September, part of a broader tax and spending plan signed over the summer.

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Watchdog to CPS: Reform ‘exorbitant’ travel policies

By Kate Armanini
Chicago Tribune

Chicago Public Schools' Office of the Inspector General is urging district officials to reform travel policies amid “questionable, excessive and even exorbitant” spending on overnight trips, according to a report released Wednesday.

CPS travel expenditures, including airfare and lodging, more than doubled between fiscal year 2019 and 2024, surging from \$3.6 million to \$77 million, the report said.

Over and over, CPS staffers exceeded spending limits, bypassed required preapprovals and expensed activities “of dubious necessity or value to students.”

“Many taxpayers would find some excursions described in this report objectionable and even excessive — especially in tight budget times,” the report said.

The Office of the Inspector General is the independent oversight body for CPS, charged with investigating allegations of financial mismanagement, fraud and employee misconduct. Its recent findings come on the heels of the district's protracted budget battle — a saga that left officials cash-strapped and scrambling to prevent classroom cuts. CPS faced a \$734 million deficit before passing a \$10.2 billion budget in August.

In response to the findings,

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INSIDE

Mayor weighs change to head tax plan

Amid an ongoing struggle to secure City Council approval, Mayor Brandon Johnson's team has been floating a change to his corporate head tax proposal that would increase the minimum size of companies affected from 100 to 200 employees. **Chicagoland, Page 5**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 55 Low 38

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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